



Toronto College[™]
of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries^{Inc.}

Accessibility Policy



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Statement of Commitment

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to ensuring equal access and participation for people with disabilities. We are committed to treating people with disabilities in a way that allows them to maintain their dignity and independence. We believe in integration and we are committed to meeting the needs of people with disabilities in a timely manner. We will do so by removing and preventing barriers to accessibility and meeting our accessibility requirements under the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act and Ontario's accessibility laws.

TCDHA is committed to meeting its current and ongoing obligations under the Ontario Human Rights Code respecting non-discrimination. TCDHA understands that obligations under the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA) and its accessibility standards do not substitute or limit its obligations under the Ontario Human Rights Code or obligations to people with disabilities under any other law.

TCDHA is committed to excellence in serving and providing goods, services or facilities to all customers including people with disabilities. Our accessible customer service policies are consistent with the principles of independence, dignity, integration and equality of opportunity for people with disabilities.

Dr. Boris Pulec, Dean of Students

Ms. Lidia DiNicolo, Chief Executive Officer

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc.



Training

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) is committed to training all staff and volunteers in accessible customer service, applicable accessibility standards under the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 (AODA), and the Ontario Human Rights Code as it relates to persons with disabilities.

Individuals in the following positions will receive training:

- Management
- Support Staff
- Didactic Faculty
- Clinical Faculty
- Clinical Dispensary Staff

Training will be provided as soon as practicable and no later than three (3) weeks after hire to all employees, volunteers, and others who interact with the public or act on behalf of the organization.

General Training

All individuals in the roles identified above will receive training on:

- An overview of the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 and the requirements of the Customer Service Standard
- TCDHA's accessibility policies and practices related to customer service
- How to interact and communicate effectively with people with various types of disabilities
- How to interact with people who use assistive devices or who are supported by a service animal or support person
- What to do if a person with a disability is having difficulty accessing TCDHA's goods, services, or facilities
- The requirements of the Ontario Human Rights Code as they relate to persons with disabilities, including the duty to accommodate



Role-Specific Training

In addition to the general training above, Clinical Faculty and Clinical Dispensary Staff will receive training on the use of on-site assistive equipment and resources (e.g., wheelchair, oxygen, or other devices that may assist in providing services to individuals with disabilities).

Ongoing Training and Records

TCDHA will provide updated training whenever there are changes to accessibility policies or practices and ensure that training is appropriate to each individual's role and responsibilities.

TCDHA will maintain records of all training provided, including the dates and the number of individuals trained.

Assistive Devices

People with disabilities may use their personal assistive devices when accessing our goods, services or facilities.

In cases where the assistive device presents a significant and unavoidable health or safety concern or may not be permitted for other reasons, other measures will be used to ensure the person with a disability can access our goods, services or facilities.

We ensure that our staff are trained and familiar with various assistive devices we have on site or that we provide that may be used by customers with disabilities while accessing our goods, services or facilities.

Accessible Information and Communication

We will communicate with people with disabilities in ways that consider their disability. We also make any notices of changes, closures or anything that



impact accessibility either verbally, on our front door (poster) and/or on the website.

Communication supports might include:

- Allowing the individual to write out their request
- Use of a translator
- Assistive listening systems (students may be approved for use of a reader)
- Reading information aloud
- Alternative versions of documents may be provided (physical copies, digital copies etc.)

Students are able to request textbooks in alternative formats through the publishers. Textbooks are already print-based however for those who may require digital textbooks, they can submit their request to the publisher directly or purchase the digital version. Toronto College of Dental Hygiene does not currently have a physical library at the college.

As a post-secondary institution offering clinically based programs, TCDHA will provide accommodations in accordance with the Ontario Human Rights Code, up to the point of undue hardship, taking into account health, safety, and academic requirements of the program. Certain programs, such as Dental Hygiene and Intra Oral Dental Assisting, require the development and demonstration of essential skills, including but not limited to reading, writing, and effective communication in English, as well as the physical ability to safely and competently perform clinical procedures (e.g., handling instruments, taking X-rays, and working within the oral cavity).

TCDHA will assess all accommodation requests on an individual basis to determine appropriate supports. Students are encouraged to contact the Program Director to discuss their accommodation needs.

We will consult with the person making the request in determining the suitability of an accessible format or communication support. If the organization determines that information or communications are unconvertible, the organization shall provide the requestor with:



- a) an explanation as to why the information or communications are unconvertible; and
- b) a summary of the unconvertible information or communications.

TCDHA will meet WCAG 2.0 Level AA requirements and will work toward alignment with WCAG 2.1 standards as best practice.

Service Animals

We welcome people with disabilities and their service animals. Service animals are allowed on the parts of our premises that are open to the public.

If it is not readily apparent that the animal is a service animal, staff may request documentation from a regulated health professional confirming the need. Those customers accessing dental hygiene care that require a service animal may be accommodated in a private dental operatory based on clinical requirements or at the individual's request.

A service animal can be easily identified through visual indicators, such as when it wears a harness or a vest, or when it helps the person perform certain tasks.

A regulated health professional is defined as a member of one of the following colleges:

- College of Audiologists and Speech-Language Pathologists of Ontario
- College of Chiropractors of Ontario
- College of Nurses of Ontario
- College of Occupational Therapists of Ontario
- College of Optometrists of Ontario
- College of Physicians and Surgeons of Ontario
- College of Physiotherapists of Ontario



- College of Psychologists of Ontario
- College of Registered Psychotherapists and Registered Mental Health Therapists of Ontario

If service animals are prohibited by another law, we will do the following to ensure people with disabilities can access our goods, services or facilities:

- a) explain why the animal is excluded
- b) discuss with the customer another way of providing goods, services or facilities.

Support Persons

A person with a disability who is accompanied by a support person will be allowed to have that person accompany them on our premises.

Fees will not be charged for support persons for admission to the Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries premises.

We will notify of this through a notice posted on our premises and the notification there will be no charge to the support person.

In certain cases, TCDHA might approve a support person for the health or safety reasons of the person with a disability and/or others on the premises.

Before making a decision, the management will:

- a) consult with the person with a disability to understand their needs
- b) consider health or safety reasons based on available evidence
- c) determine if there is no other reasonable way to protect the health or safety of the person or others on the premises.

Notice of Temporary Disruption

In the event of a planned or unexpected disruption to services or facilities for customers with disabilities such as wheelchair assistance, defibrillator and



oxygen, the Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries will notify customers promptly. This clearly posted notice will include information about the reason for the disruption, its anticipated length of time, and a description of alternative facilities or services, if available.

The notice will be placed at the door of the front receptionist and dental clinic at the main campus at 2727 Steeles Ave West, North York, Ontario, M3J 3G9 and 28 Vanley Crescent, North York, ON M3J 2B8.

Feedback Process

Customers who wish to provide feedback on the way that the Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. provides goods and services to people with disabilities can contact Compliance and Business Director, Dr. Yelena Mordovskaya by email, BusinessDirector@toronto-college-dental.org and/or complete a client survey for the TCDHA suggestion and feedback box. All feedback will be reviewed and addressed, where applicable, within 30 business days.

The feedback process is accessible to persons with disabilities upon request, and accessible formats or communication supports will be provided as needed.

Complaints will be addressed according to the organization's complaint management procedures.

Notice of Availability of Documents

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries will notify the public that documents related to accessible customer service, are available upon request by posting a notice in various formats:

- Online
- Print
- Verbal

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries will provide this document in



an accessible format or with communication support, on request. We will consult with the person making the request to determine the suitability of the format or communication support. We will provide the accessible format in a timely manner and, at no additional cost.

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries will strive to provide improvements for individuals with disabilities in the format of:

- Online student portal
- Textbooks and educational software
- Classroom teaching technologies and equipment

Employment

We notify employees, job applicants and the public that accommodations can be made during recruitment and hiring. We notify job applicants when they are individually selected to participate in an assessment or selection process that accommodations are available upon request. We consult with the applicants and provide or arrange for suitable accommodation.

We notify successful applicants of policies for accommodating employees with disabilities when making offers of employment.

We notify staff that supports are available for those with disabilities as soon as practicable after they begin their employment. We provide updated information to employees whenever there is a change to existing policies on the provision of job accommodation that consider an employee's accessibility needs due to a disability.

We will consult with employees when arranging for the provision of suitable accommodation in a manner that considers the accessibility needs due to disability. We will consult with the person making the request in determining the suitability of an accessible format or communication supports specifically for:

- a) information that is needed in order to perform the employee's job; and
- b) information that is generally available to employees in the workplace

If an employee has a disability, whether permanent or temporary, and may need help during an emergency, they must inform the Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. The employee will be asked to complete a self-assessment form, and then we will work with them to develop individualized emergency response information that will meet the employee's needs in an emergency situation.

TCDHA will develop and maintain a documented return-to-work process for employees who have been absent due to a disability and require disability-related accommodations. TCDHA will develop and maintain documented individual accommodation plans for employees with disabilities.

Please note that we do not need to know the details of their medical condition or disability, only the kind of help they may need. The information they provide will be kept confidential and only shared with their consent.

We will review the individualized workplace emergency response information:

- a) when the employee moves to a different location in the organization;
- b) when the employee's overall accommodations needs or plans are reviewed; and
- c) when the employer reviews its general emergency response policies.

Changes to Existing Policies

Any policy of the Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries that does not respect and promote the dignity and independence of people with disabilities will be modified and removed. These reviews will occur on a regular basis and when legislative or operational changes arise.